

\$82.1M of indirect spend, and one category is eight times the peer median.

Indirect spend is the recurring operating cost that sits outside your program delivery and outside your payroll — it is the only thing we work. What follows compares the categories your Form 990 names separately against organizations of comparable size and type: a starting point for a question, never a verdict on how you are run.

\$82.1M

INDIRECT SPEND, AS FILED

Salaries, depreciation and interest are excluded — they are not indirect and not ours to work.

\$43.7M

NAMED BY CATEGORY

A further \$38.46M sits in lines the filing does not name. ERA works 55 categories; the baseline covers every one that applies.

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PRIORITY THE RECORD CAN
ALREADY EVIDENCE

Operating supply, at the 98th percentile of 2,573 filers.

Evidence depth: four of nine layers carry something for this organization — filed, benchmark, derived and registry. Operating, retrieved, engagement and verified are empty, and are shown as empty rather than filled.

Where each category sits

CATEGORY — AND WHAT IT IS IN YOUR OPERATION	FILED	YOUR % OF REVENUE	PEER MEDIAN	POSITION	WHAT ERA HAS RECOVERED HERE
Operating Supply Running the stores and processing donated goods	\$37.97M	19.36%	2.40%	Well above · 98th	27% median · 89 projects
Freight / Small Parcel Moving donated goods between sites and to customers	\$2.63M	1.34%	0.79%	Above · 64th	29% median · 112 projects
Marketing Services Donor and retail advertising	\$482K	0.25%	0.26%	Below · 49th	—
Fleet Management The trucks that collect donations	\$2.12M	1.08%	1.21%	Below · 46th	18% median · 17 projects
Travel Staff movement across the programme	\$450K	0.23%	0.37%	Below · 39th	—

Each category is compared against every nonprofit filer that breaks it out separately, as a share of total revenue. A category needs at least 30 filers before we state a position, and the categories a filing does not break out are sized in the baseline, not here.

Why operating supply comes first

At **19.4% of revenue** against a **2.4% peer median** it is roughly eight times, on 2,573 filers. A donated-goods retailer genuinely buys more supply than most nonprofits, so part of that gap is your model rather than your buying — how much is exactly the question. ERA has completed **89 operating-supply engagements at a median of 27%**.

Being at the median is not the same as being competitive

The median is drawn from organizations that have mostly never market-tested these categories either. It describes what is *normal*, not what is *available*. Of **2,660 completed ERA engagements, 2,649 recovered value** — a median of 28% of category spend, and the weakest quarter still returned 14%. Almost none of those clients were outliers on a filing.

FILED Form 990 Part IX, FY2024 · **BENCHMARK** per-category cohorts as shown, 30-filer minimum · **ERA RECOVERY** completed engagements, median of category spend. Operating, retrieved, engagement and verified are absent. Full sources overleaf.